

Aditri Vaishnavi Balaji
BASIS Independent Silicon Valley
1290 Parkmoor Ave, San Jose, CA

Parker T. Johnson
Steward Observatory
The University of Arizona
933 North Cherry Avenue, Tucson, AZ

25 May 2026

The Editorial Office
Monthly Notices of the Royal Astronomical Society

Dear Editor,

We submit the enclosed manuscript, “A morphological barrier: quantifying the injection realism gap for CNN strong lens finders in DESI Legacy Survey DR10,” for consideration as a Paper in MNRAS.

This manuscript has not been published previously and is not under consideration by any other journal. All authors have read the final version and approved its submission.

AI tool disclosure. Per MNRAS policy, we note that AI language models (Claude, Anthropic; ChatGPT, OpenAI) were used as coding assistants during the development of analysis scripts and for manuscript copy-editing. All AI-assisted code was reviewed, tested, and verified by the authors, who are solely responsible for the scientific content of this paper.

We have no preferred or non-preferred editors or reviewers.

The authors declare no conflicts of interest.

Yours sincerely,

Aditri Vaishnavi Balaji
Parker T. Johnson